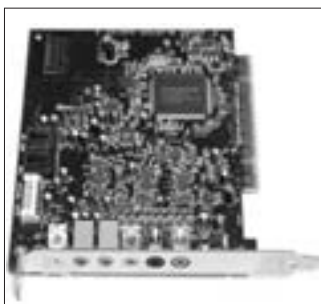


Creative calls the Audigy Value “the upgrade solution for basic motherboard audio to high quality 24-bit, 7.1 audio.” Audio quality is 24-bit / 96 kHz with a 100 dB SNR. The Audigy 2 Value is a minor upgrade of the same card. The Audigy 2 NX is an external USB 2.0 sound solution. The Audigy 2 ZS features Creative’s 24-bit Advanced HD audio quality playback with an SNR of 108 dB, and supports DVD Audio at 24-bit / 192kHz in stereo or 24-bit / 96kHz in 5.1 surround.



At the upper end of the spectrum is the Audigy 4 Pro, which pumps the SNR up to 113 dB, and which supports recording of six channels at 24-bit / 96 kHz. The Entertainment Center software and infrared remote allow easy navigation through movies, music and pictures. The Audigy 4 Pro has an external I/O hub that allows you to connect all your music devices at one time for studio-quality audio creation, according to Creative. The PCI card connects to the external hub, with the line outputs (three 3.5 mm stereo jacks) on the PCI card and all the other connections on the hub.



Indicative prices are about Rs 2,200 for the Audigy Value, Rs 7,000 for the Audigy 2 NX, and Rs 20,000 for the Audigy 4 Pro.

X-Fi

The Creative X-Fi is supposed to be 24 times more powerful than its predecessor, the Audigy 2 ZS, in terms of processing power. Unlike any earlier audio technology, the X-Fi Xtreme Fidelity audio processor allows the user to switch the sound processing of the card between one of three modes (Gaming, Entertainment and Audio Creation).